

CSE 459: Professional Ethics and Communication for Engineering

Valuing time



Civic virtue

Civic virtue refers to the moral behavior of citizens in relation to their involvement in society. It encompasses qualities and actions that promote the well-being of the community and the success of a democratic society. These virtues often involve participation, responsibility, and a commitment to the common good.

Even though Civic virtue includes qualities like honesty, integrity, fairness, and respect for others. It's about making ethical choices in all aspects of life, including those that affect the community.



Civic virtue

Nevertheless this involves actively participating in the community, whether through volunteering, voting, or other forms of civic participation. It's about contributing to the well-being of the community and working towards the common good. However, it also means that citizens acquire civic virtue by being actively engaged with political and judicial practices. Thus, elements of both governing and being governed properly belong within Aristotle's framework for the education of a free person as a citizen.



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Examples:

**Civic virtue can be demonstrated through various actions,
such as:**

- Voting in elections.**
- Volunteering time to help others or improve the community.**
- Respecting the law and participating in the democratic process.**
- Working to resolve conflicts constructively.**
- Being informed about public issues and participating in public discourse.**

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Civic virtue uses in Volunteering time to help others

Civic virtue, in the context of volunteering, manifests as a citizen's commitment to the well-being of their community, going beyond personal needs to actively contribute to its improvement. Volunteering, therefore, becomes a practical expression of civic virtue, demonstrating a willingness to dedicate time and effort to help others and enhance the community.



How civic virtue is used in volunteering:

1. Social Responsibility and Compassion: Civic virtue encourages individuals to recognize their interconnectedness with the community and act with compassion towards others. Volunteering provides a tangible way to translate this sense of social responsibility into action, addressing needs and promoting the collective good.



How civic virtue is used in volunteering:

2. Enhancing Community Life: Through volunteering, individuals contribute to various aspects of community life, such as supporting vulnerable populations, improving public spaces, and promoting education or cultural enrichment. This active participation strengthens community bonds and fosters a sense of belonging.



How civic virtue is used in volunteering:

3. Promoting Democratic Values: Volunteering fosters democratic values by encouraging active citizenship and participation in civic life. It strengthens the fabric of society by demonstrating that citizens are invested in the well-being of their community and are willing to work together for the common good.

How civic virtue is used in volunteering:

4. Developing Essential Skills: Volunteering can provide individuals with valuable skills, such as teamwork, communication, problem-solving, and leadership, which are essential for active participation in society. These skills can be applied to various aspects of life, contributing to personal growth and further engagement in civic life.

How civic virtue is used in volunteering:

5. Inspiring Others: Individuals who demonstrate civic virtue through volunteering can inspire others to do the same, creating a ripple effect of positive change within the community. This can lead to a more engaged and vibrant society where citizens actively participate in shaping their community's future. In essence, volunteering is a practical manifestation of civic virtue, reflecting a commitment to the well-being of the community and a willingness to contribute to its betterment. It fosters social responsibility, strengthens communities, and promotes democratic values.

Valuing time

Valuing time means recognizing its importance in our daily lives and making conscious choices about how we spend it. Efficient time management leads to increased productivity, reduced stress, and a better work-life balance.

Now since time is essential to ethics. Time enables attachment and loss, and decision-making, and regret. With time, you can change your mind. We must each decide what to do with our time, and our decisions affect benefit and harm others, as well as consuming their time to greater or lesser extent.



**WHAT IS THE
REAL VALUE
OF TIME?**

Valuing time

Ethics refers to a system of moral principles. Values are associated with the thought process, a person's sense of what is wrong and what is right. Ethics aligns with a professional setup. Values are associated with personal aspects of a person.

Time to value (TTV) is a measure of the length of time necessary to undertake a project and realize the benefits of the solution. The concept is used to help decision makers evaluate the proposed benefit of an investment in time and/or money.

Skills for ethical reasoning

Ethical reasoning skills involve the ability to identify, analyze, and evaluate situations based on ethical principles, ultimately leading to sound moral judgments and decisions. It's about making choices that are not only legally sound but also morally justifiable, considering the potential impact on individuals and society. These skills are crucial for navigating complex dilemmas and fostering ethical cultures in various settings.

Key Components of Ethical Reasoning Skills:

Identifying Ethical Issues:

Recognizing when a situation involves moral considerations and potential ethical conflicts.

Analyzing Ethical Perspectives:

Understanding different ethical frameworks and viewpoints, such as utilitarianism, deontology, or virtue ethics.

Evaluating Ethical Arguments:

Assessing the strengths and weaknesses of different ethical arguments and justifications.

Key Components of Ethical Reasoning Skills:

Considering Consequences:

Thinking about the potential short-term and long-term consequences of actions, both for oneself and others.

Applying Ethical Principles:

Using established ethical principles (like fairness, honesty, respect) to guide decision-making.

Developing Ethical Arguments:

Constructing well-reasoned arguments to support a particular ethical position.

Key Components of Ethical Reasoning Skills:

Reflecting on Values:

Examining one's own values and how they influence ethical judgments.

Making Responsible Decisions:

Choosing actions that align with one's ethical principles and contribute to a positive outcome.

Taking Ownership:

Recognizing responsibility for one's actions and their ethical implications.

Key Components of Ethical Reasoning Skills:

Promoting Ethical Culture:

Encouraging ethical behavior in others and contributing to a positive ethical environment.

Why are ethical reasoning skills important?

Navigating Complex Situations:

Ethical reasoning helps individuals and organizations make sound decisions in challenging situations with competing interests.

Promoting Integrity:

It fosters a culture of honesty, fairness, and responsibility.

Building Trust:

Ethical decision-making builds trust with stakeholders, including employees, customers, and the public.

Why are ethical reasoning skills important?

Preventing Harm:

By considering potential consequences, ethical reasoning can help prevent unethical actions that could cause harm.

Improving Relationships:

Ethical behavior fosters positive relationships based on respect and mutual understanding.

Making a Positive Impact:

Ethical reasoning enables individuals and organizations to contribute to a more just and equitable society.



**ACM Code of Ethics and
Professional Conduct**

The code of ethics of computer science and Engineering

The Code of Ethics for Computer Science and Engineering emphasizes responsible and ethical use of technology, focusing on areas like privacy, security, intellectual property, and the public interest. It guides professionals to make decisions that benefit society, avoid harm, and uphold the integrity of the profession.

The key aspects of code of ethics for computer science and Engineering

1.Core Principles:

Respect for Privacy: Protecting the privacy of individuals and not snooping in their files.

System Integrity: Maintaining the security and proper functioning of computer systems, preventing unauthorized access or damage.

Intellectual Property: Respecting copyrights, licenses, and avoiding unauthorized copying or use of software.

The key aspects of code of ethics for computer science and Engineering

Public Interest: Ensuring that technological advancements benefit society as a whole and do not cause harm.

Professionalism: Maintaining honesty, integrity, and competence in all professional activities.

Honesty and Transparency: Being truthful about system capabilities, limitations, and potential problems.

Fairness and Non-discrimination: Treating everyone with respect and avoiding bias in decision-making.

The key aspects of code of ethics for computer science and Engineering

2. Specific Considerations:

Security:

Implementing strong security measures to prevent cyberattacks, data breaches, and malware infections.

Data Integrity:

Using accurate data derived by ethical and lawful means and maintaining the integrity of data.

The key aspects of code of ethics for computer science and Engineering

Software Engineering:

Ensuring that software products meet the highest professional standards and are well-documented.

Conflict of Interest:

Avoiding conflicts of interest and disclosing them to affected parties when they exist.

Bribery and Corruption:

Rejecting bribery in all its forms.

The key aspects of code of ethics for computer science and Engineering

3. Organizations and Codes:

ACM (Association for Computing Machinery):

Has a Code of Ethics and Professional Conduct that outlines principles for responsible conduct in the field.

IEEE (Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers):

Has a Code of Ethics that emphasizes upholding the highest standards of integrity and ethical conduct.

The key aspects of code of ethics for computer science and Engineering

IEEE Computer Society:

Offers a Code of Ethics for Software Engineers, focusing on public interest, client and employer interests, product quality, and professional judgment.

The key aspects of code of ethics for computer science and Engineering

4. Key Aspects of Ethical Decision Making:

Gathering Facts: Understanding the context of the situation, including who, what, where, when, and why.

Identifying Stakeholders: Recognizing all parties who might be affected by the decision.

Analyzing Ethical Issues: Evaluating the situation from different ethical perspectives, such as consequences and duties.

The key aspects of code of ethics for computer science and Engineering

Maximizing Benefits: Choosing the option that maximizes benefits and minimizes harm to all stakeholders.

Reviewing Actions: Ensuring that all obligations to stakeholders have been met.